Country Summary: Australia



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Executive summary of the Australia country profile (2026-10-20). Superscript numbers refer to the numbered sources in Australia_Profile_DRAFT_SOURCES.docx.

At a Glance

27.9 m Population, 31 March 2026[3]	**71,930** GDP per capita, PPP (international dollars), about, 2025[6]	**10.40%** Current health expenditure, share of GDP, 2023[31]	**15.8%** Out-of-pocket share of current health expenditure, 2023[33]
4.09 Physicians per 1,000 people, 2022[36]	**2.5** Public hospital beds per 1,000 people, 2023-24[23]	**9.4%** Deaths from dementia, the leading cause, 2024[20]	**45.8%** Private hospital cover, share of population, 30 June 2026[27]

Country background

Australia, with about 27.9 million people at 31 March 2026, is a constitutional monarchy whose capital is Canberra.[1,3] Anthony Albanese continues as Prime Minister after Labor won 94 House seats in 2025, and Mark Butler is Minister for Health and Ageing.[8,15,16] The Commonwealth funds Medicare while the states run public hospitals.[18] Life expectancy at birth was 83.1 years in 2024, 87.7 percent of people lived in urban areas in 2025, and people aged 65 and over made up 18.1 percent.[10,12,13] Dementia became the leading cause of death in 2024.[20] The key risk is cost: health takes 16.4 percent of Commonwealth expenses in 2026-27, and the Budget forecasts slower growth.[17]

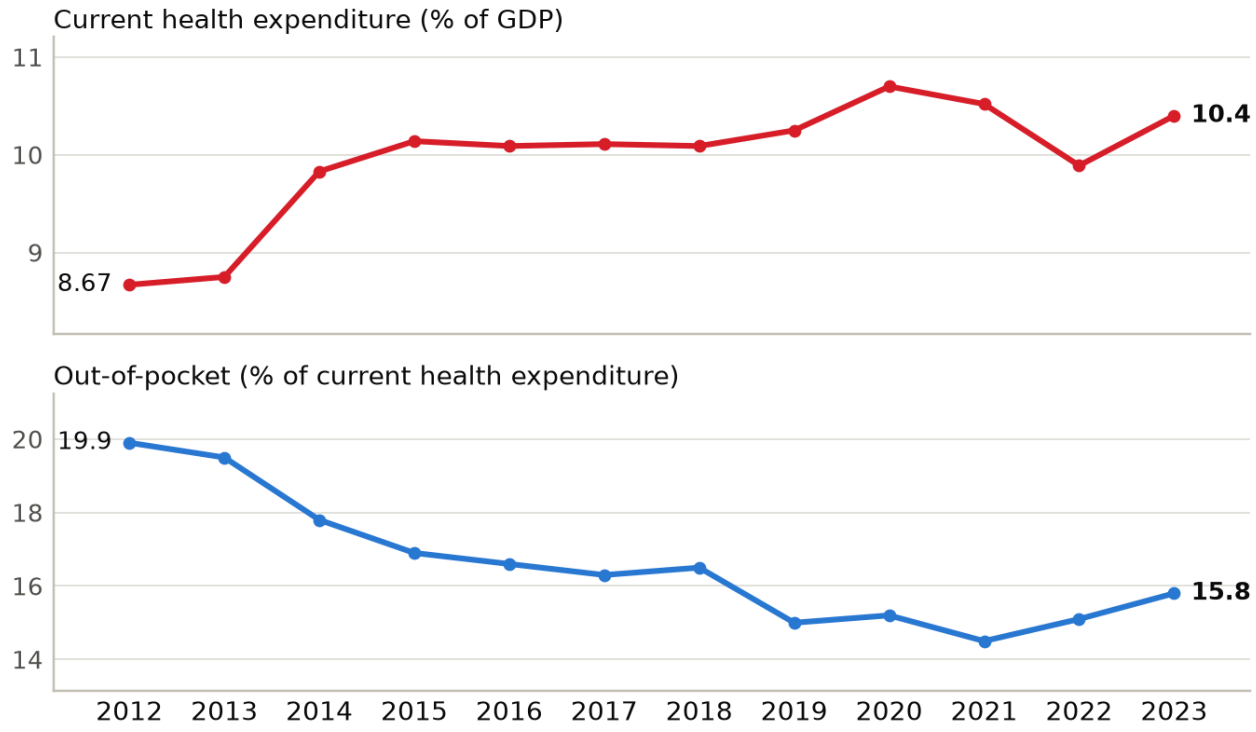
Key takeaways for CSI

- Medicare covers the full cost of public hospital services for citizens and permanent residents.[18]
- Health spending was 10.40 percent of GDP in 2023, below Canada, the United Kingdom and the United States.[31,35]
- Dementia became the leading cause of death in 2024, at 9.4 percent of deaths, overtaking ischemic heart diseases.[20]
- Governments funded 70 percent of the A$290.7 billion in total health spending in 2024-25.[30]

Health System

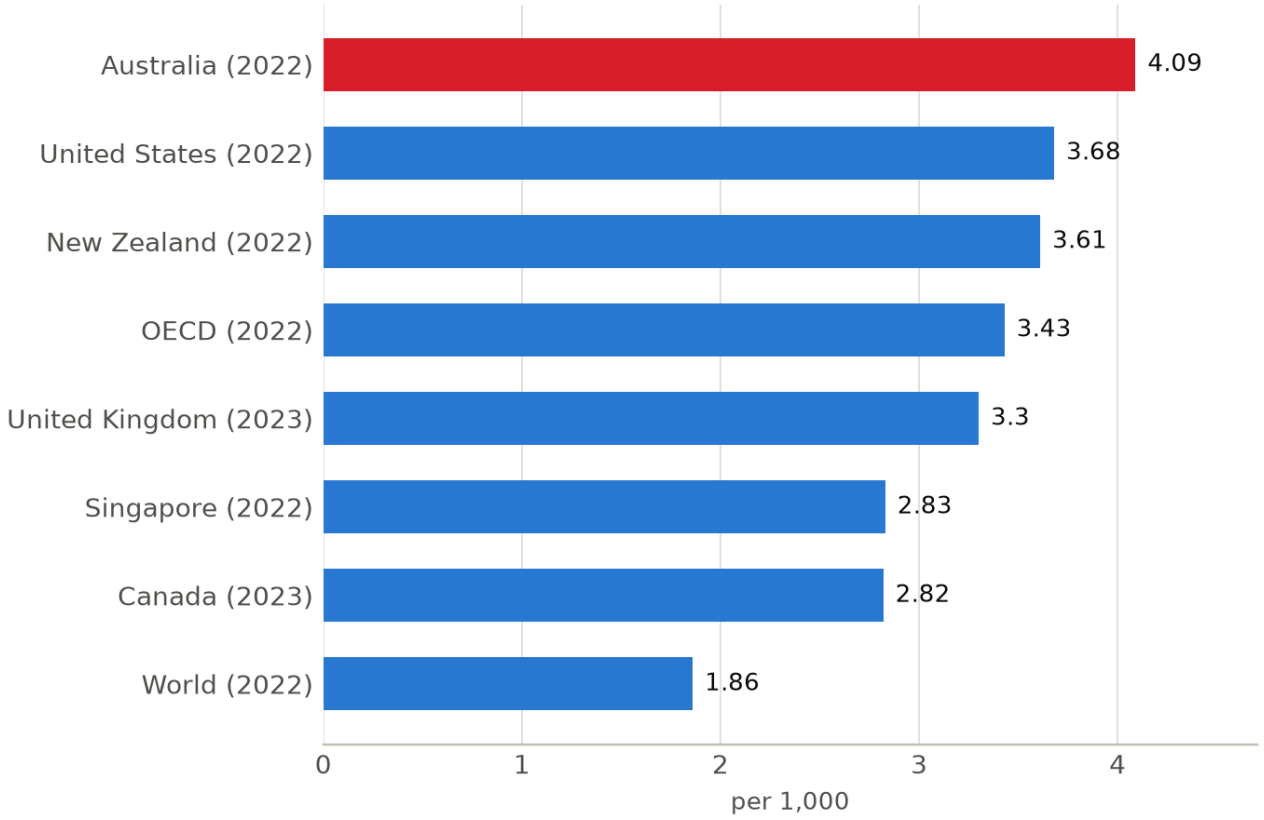
- The 2026-27 Budget provides A$220.3 billion over five years for state public hospital services.[24]
- Bulk billing incentives reached all Australians on 1 November 2025, with 9 in 10 GP visits projected by 2030.[25,26]
- Public hospitals had 67,280 beds in 2023-24, and governments funded 94 percent of their A$103.1 billion recurrent spending.[23]

Australia: health spending and out-of-pocket share, 2012 to 2023



Current health expenditure as a share of GDP, and out-of-pocket spending as a share of current health expenditure. Sources: [31,33]

Physicians per 1,000 people, Australia and comparators (latest year available)

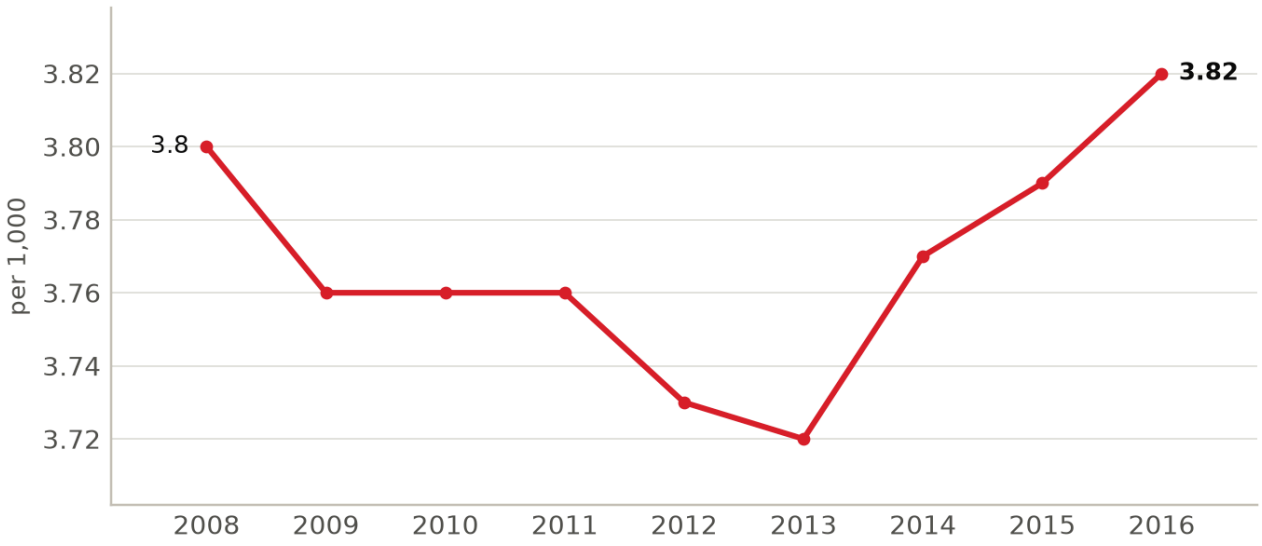


Latest year available for each country in the World Bank series, shown in brackets; comparison years differ (2022 and 2023). Sources: [72]

Market and Competition

- Ramsay Health Care, listed on the Australian Securities Exchange since 1997, runs hospitals in Australia, Europe and the United Kingdom.[29]
- Healthscope, the second-largest operator, entered receivership in May 2025 after Brookfield withdrew support.[28]
- Peter MacCallum Cancer Centre signed with Dana-Farber in 2022 and The Christie in 2024.[47,48] The tracker lists 18 active foreign ties.

Australia: hospital beds per 1,000 people, 2008 to 2016



Hospital beds as reported to the World Bank; 2016 is the latest year in the series. Sources: [38]

Foreign health systems active in Australia

18 foreign institutions with confirmed active partnerships (18 in all): 13 research collaboration, 5 training and education. Sources in the profile and the partnerships tracker.



Active foreign health-system partnerships by city of the partner in Australia. Source: CSI partnerships tracker, verified 2026-10-20. Boundaries: Natural Earth; not an official depiction.

Institution	Nature of collaboration
Boston Children's Hospital	Research collaboration
Cleveland Clinic	Training and education
Emory University	Research collaboration
Memorial Sloan Kettering Cancer Center	Research collaboration
Ochsner Health	Training and education
Weill Cornell Medicine	Research collaboration

Institution	Nature of collaboration
Apollo Hospitals	Research collaboration
Great Ormond Street Hospital and UCL Great Ormond Street Institute of Child Health	Research collaboration
Ho Chi Minh City Eye Hospital	Training and education
Hokkaido University (Faculty of Health Sciences)	Training and education
Manipal Academy of Higher Education (MAHE)	Research collaboration
Max Healthcare	Research collaboration
Sichuan Provincial People's Hospital	Research collaboration
The Chinese Medicine Hospital of Hong Kong	Research collaboration
The Christie NHS Foundation Trust	Training and education
The Hospital for Sick Children (SickKids)	Research collaboration
University of Galway (BioInnovate Ireland)	Research collaboration
West China Hospital, Sichuan University	Research collaboration

CSI Position, Risks and Recent News

CSI partnerships in Australia

[MANUAL INPUT REQUIRED]

To be completed by CSI from internal data; not researched.

Opportunities for CSI

[MANUAL INPUT REQUIRED]

To be completed by CSI from internal data; not researched.

Risks and watch items

- The Budget forecasts growth slowing to 1.75 percent in 2026-27 because the Middle East conflict raised global oil prices.[17]
- Four in five specialists registered in the pathway's first six months work in major cities, Medical Republic reported.[40]
- Dementia deaths rose 39 percent over a decade, and 49.9 percent of people had a chronic condition in 2022.[20,22]

Recent developments

2026-01-30 National Cabinet agreed a new public hospital funding deal with A$25 billion in additional Commonwealth public hospital funding.[8]

2026-05-12 The Budget removes the age-based uplift of the private health insurance rebate from 1 April 2027.[24]

2026-09-14 Healthscope's 25 hospitals will be divided among four operators, with Calvary Health Care taking 14.[28]